AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER



The Workshop

Utilities & Swiss-Army Tools

44	6	100%
FREE TOOLS	FLAGSHIP PICKS	FREE / OPEN

2026 Edition — every link re-verified 2026-10-15.
License-aware curation: copyleft, freemium and free-tier entries are tagged inline.
Part of **Awesome Cyber Security Heaven** — 438 curated tools across 14 realms.

ABOUT THIS REALM

The Workshop — Utilities & Swiss-Army Tools

The everyday carry — decoding, proxying, dissecting and transforming anything the job throws at you.

The swiss-army shelf: netcat-lineage utilities, intercept proxies, transport plumbing (Tor, socat), debuggers and format-inspectors. Unspecialized by definition — the tools you reach for when nothing specialized fits.

- **Active in the last 30 days:** 21 of 35 tracked GitHub repos (60%)
- **Quiet classics (no push in 2+ years, still the standard):** Awesome Malware Analysis
- **Youngest entries:** mitmproxy (2010), Netron (2010), radare2 (2012)

THE COLLECTION

All 44 tools — with live facts

Every entry below was checked against the GitHub API on 2026-10-15: star counts, project ages, last-push dates and licenses are re-snapshotted on every monthly verification pass. Flagship picks carry the **FLAGSHIP** badge — the tools this realm is built around. Everything is free, free-tier or open source: no paywalls, no SaaS wrappers.

Ghidra ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 88.3k · since 2019 · pushed 2026-10-15

the NSA's open-source reverse-engineering suite; disassembly, decompilation and scripting for free.

`github.com/NationalSecurityAgency/ghidra`

ImHex ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 55.2k · since 2020 · pushed 2026-10-09 · GPL-2.0

the hex editor with pattern language: parse formats while you view them.

`github.com/WerWolv/ImHex`

x64dbg ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 49.9k | since 2015 | pushed 2026-10-09 | GPL-3.0

the open Windows debugger for x32/x64, with a plugin ecosystem built for RE.

`github.com/x64dbg/x64dbg`

mitmproxy ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 45.6k | since 2010 | pushed 2026-10-13

interactive HTTPS interception for debugging and testing your own apps; scriptable as a library.

`github.com/mitmproxy/mitmproxy`

CyberChef ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 36.1k | since 2016 | pushed 2026-10-15

GCHQ's web Swiss-army knife: 400+ operations for decoding, transforming and analyzing data, all client-side.

`github.com/gchq/CyberChef`

Netron ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 33.6k | since 2010 | pushed 2026-10-14 | MIT

visualize ML models: the layers, weights and graph of what you deploy.

`github.com/lutzroeder/netron`

OpenSSL

★ 30.9k | since 2013 | pushed 2026-10-15

the TLS library the internet runs on — and the CLI for keys, certs, CSRs and everything crypto.

`github.com/openssl/openssl`

radare2

★ 25.0k | since 2012 | pushed 2026-10-15 | LGPL-3.0

the scriptable reverse-engineering framework: disassemble, debug, patch, anywhere.

`github.com/radareorg/radare2`

Frida

★ 22.3k · since 2013 · pushed 2026-10-15 · GPL-2.0 / wxWindows dual

inject JavaScript into running processes; dynamic instrumentation for mobile, desktop and IoT.

`github.com/frida/frida`

Ciphey

★ 21.7k · since 2019 · pushed 2026-10-13

automated decoder: paste ciphertext, get plaintext plus the method used — evidence triage in seconds.

`github.com/Ciphey/Ciphey`

binwalk

★ 14.5k · since 2013 · pushed 2026-08-11 · MIT

firmware analysis: scan, extract and identify embedded files and filesystems.

`github.com/ReFirmLabs/binwalk`

Awesome Malware Analysis

★ 14.3k · since 2015 · pushed 2024-06-07 ⏳ · CC-BY-4.0, curated list

the curated malware-analysis tool index.

`github.com/rshipp/awesome-malware-analysis`

Scapy

★ 12.6k · since 2015 · pushed 2026-10-11 · GPL-2.0

packet crafting without limits: forge, sniff, dissect and send anything — the Python network Swiss-army knife.

`github.com/secdev/scapy`

Detect It Easy

★ 11.7k · since 2014 · pushed 2026-10-15 · MIT

packer/compiler/protection detection with a rule engine.

`github.com/horsicq/Detect-It-Easy`

dnSpyEx

★ 11.3k · since 2021 · pushed 2026-10-14 · GPL-3.0

the .NET debugger and decompiler, continued; edit assemblies live.

`github.com/dnSpyEx/dnSpy`

pwndbg

★ 11.1k · since 2015 · pushed 2026-10-12 · MIT

GDB with a exploit-dev UX: heap awareness, shortcuts and sane defaults.

`github.com/pwndbg/pwndbg`

Capstone

★ 9.1k · since 2013 · pushed 2026-10-14 · BSD-3-Clause

the disassembly framework behind countless security tools.

`github.com/capstone-engine/capstone`

pyWhat

★ 7.3k · since 2021 · pushed 2026-10-13

identify anything: hashes, keys, URLs, PII — the "what is this string?" answer.

`github.com/bee-san/pyWhat`

Faraday

★ 6.8k · since 2013 · pushed 2026-10-06 · GPL-3.0

the pentest collaboration platform: import tool output, deduplicate findings and manage the whole engagement.

`github.com/infobyte/faraday`

Voltron

★ 6.3k · since 2013 · pushed 2025-01-30 ⏳ · MIT

a debugger-agnostic UI: multiple synchronized views across GDB/LLDB.

`github.com/snare/voltron`

Dangerzone

★ 5.8k · since 2020 · pushed 2026-10-15 · AGPL-3.0

takes hostile documents and re-renders them as safe PDFs inside an isolated sandbox.

`github.com/freedomofpress/dangerzone`

UEFITool

★ 5.7k · since 2013 · pushed 2026-07-29 · BSD-2-Clause

parse, extract and replace UEFI firmware images.

`github.com/LongSoft/UEFITool`

ExifTool

★ 5.2k · since 2018 · pushed 2026-05-27 · Perl Artistic/GPL

the metadata reader/writer for files and images; the last word in metadata triage.

`github.com/exiftool/exiftool`

Kaitai Struct

★ 4.7k · since 2016 · pushed 2026-10-14 · MIT

declare a binary format once, generate parsers for nine languages.

`github.com/kaitai-io/kaitai_struct`

Interactsh

★ 4.6k · since 2021 · pushed 2026-10-12

out-of-band interaction server for detecting blind vulnerabilities (SSRF, blind RCE, blind XXE).

`github.com/projectdiscovery/interactsh`

ATT&CK Navigator

★ 2.5k · since 2018 · pushed 2026-10-13

MITRE's matrix explorer: layer, annotate and score ATT&CK techniques for detection-coverage planning.

`github.com/mitre-attack/attack-navigator`

boofuzz

★ 2.4k · since 2015 · pushed 2026-09-21 · GPL-2.0

network protocol fuzzing framework descended from Sulley — script your protocol and hardware bug hunts.

`github.com/jtpereyda/boofuzz`

Brida

★ 1.9k · since 2017 · pushed 2025-10-30 · MIT

the bridge between Burp and Frida: custom instrumentation in your proxy workflow.

`github.com/federicodotta/Brida`

tcpreplay

★ 1.4k · since 2013 · pushed 2026-08-15 · GPL-3.0

replay captured traffic at arbitrary speed for testing and validation.

`github.com/appneta/tcpreplay`

GnuPG

★ 991 · since 2015 · pushed 2026-10-14 · GPL-3.0

the free implementation of OpenPGP: encrypt, sign and verify files and mail, everywhere.

`github.com/gpg/gnupg`

OCSF

★ 900 · since 2022 · pushed 2026-10-13 · Apache-2.0

the Open Cybersecurity Schema Framework: one schema for security events.

`github.com/ocsf/ocsf-schema`

Dradis CE

★ 843 · since 2016 · pushed 2026-10-15 · GPL-2.0

collaborative pentest reporting: team notes, evidence and findings assembled into one professional report.

`github.com/dradis/dradis-ce`

Hachoir

★ 672 · since 2016 · pushed 2026-10-14 · GPL-2.0

binary field inspection: split any file into its fields, even damaged ones.

`github.com/vstinner/hachoir`

friTap

★ 555 · since 2021 · pushed 2026-09-29 · GPL-3.0

intercept TLS keys in real time for analysis; a Frida script for the lab.

`github.com/fkie-cad/friTap`

boxxy

★ 85 · since 2017 · pushed 2025-01-23 ⏳ · LGPL-2.1

a rules-based sandbox for misbehaving programs; redirects what they touch.

`github.com/kpcyrd/boxxy-rs`

Wireshark

GPL-2.0

the packet analyzer everyone knows; deep protocol visibility for troubleshooting and forensics.

`wireshark.org`

tcpdump

the command-line packet capture classic; quick looks and long captures where Wireshark won't fit.

`tcpdump.org`

socat

GPL-2.0

the relay for bidirectional data transfer between addresses: TCP, UDP, sockets, pipes.

`dest-unreach.org/socat/`

netcat

freeware

the original TCP/IP Swiss army knife: reads and writes across networks with one command.

`nc110.sourceforge.io/`

I2P

the Invisible Internet Project: anonymous, self-organizing overlay network. (multiple open licenses)

`geti2p.net/`

Tails

GPL-3.0

the amnesic incognito live system: no trace left on the machine.

`tails.boum.org/`

Hex Fiend

BSD-2-Clause

the fast, open-source hex editor for macOS.

`ridiculousfish.com/hexfiend/`

angr

BSD-2-Clause

the binary-analysis platform from UCSB's Shellphish: symbolic execution at scale.

`angr.io/`

Evan's Debugger

GPL-2.0+

the C/C++ debugger with a RE focus: memory views built for analysis.

`codef00.com/projects#debugger`



Keep this realm alive

Awesome Cyber Security Heaven is a hand-curated, license-verified map of 438 free cybersecurity tools across 14 realms — maintained, re-verified and free forever (CC0). Star the repo, propose a tool, or explore the other 13 realms.

Featured: 2MNY Website Vulnerability Scanner

200 free, self-hosted protection modules — SQLi, XSS, SSRF, subdomain takeover, CMS and AI-stack checks with evidence-backed, CVSS-scored reports. One Docker command, zero API keys.

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven
2mny.com

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